



Karunisai: Ragas for Recovery

Music for Healing

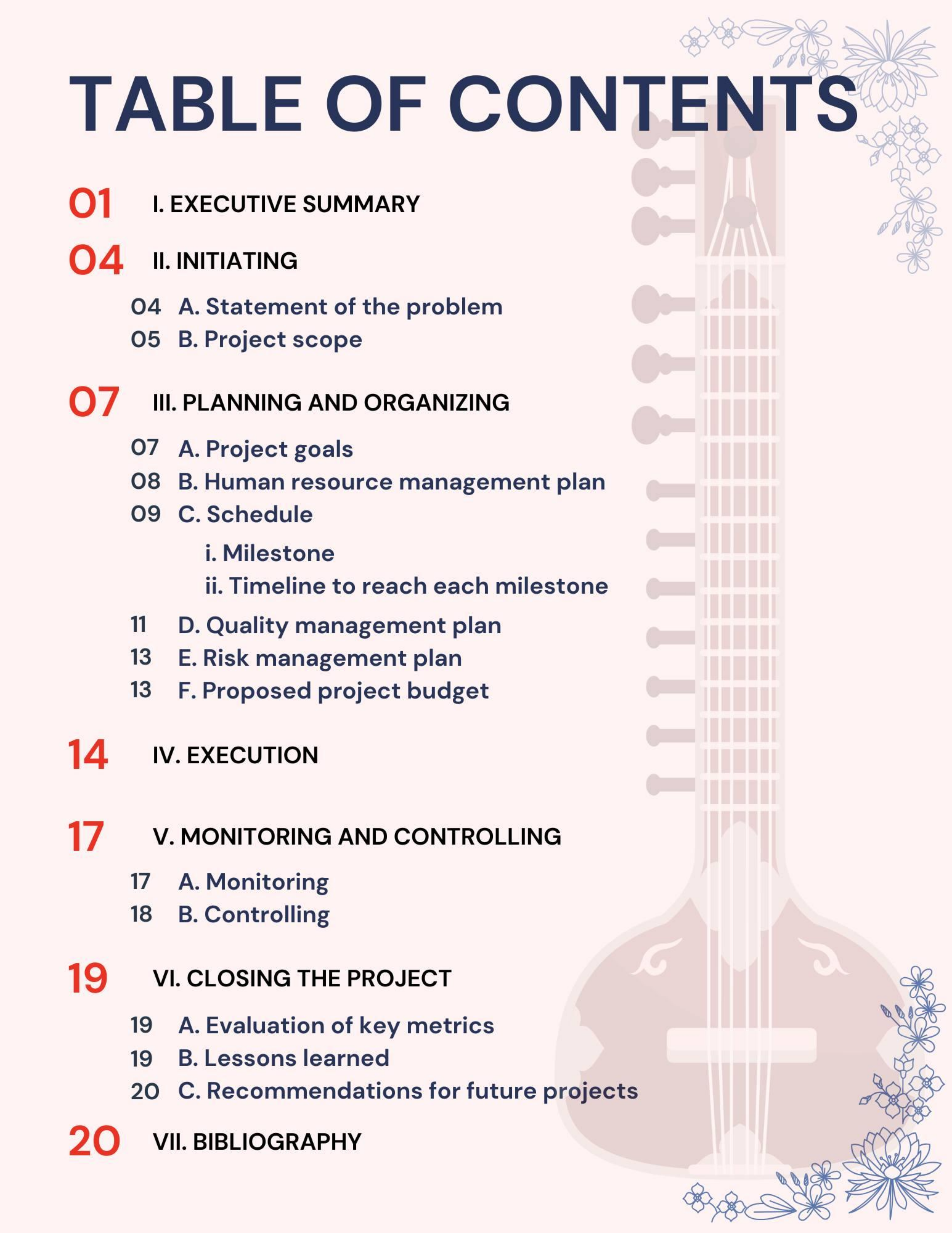
2024
2025



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Community Giving Project
Bothell High School
9130 NE 180th St, Bothell, WA 98011
April 8th, 2025



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The page features a decorative background with a faint, light-colored illustration of a guitar body and neck on the right side. The guitar is oriented vertically, with the headstock at the top and the body at the bottom. The body is a light beige color with a darker beige soundhole. The neck is a light brown color with frets. The headstock has six tuning pegs. The background is also decorated with various blue and white floral patterns, including small flowers and larger, more complex designs, scattered across the page.

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I. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

INITIATING

Problem: The small town of Chankanai, located Jaffna District, Sri Lanka, faces many healthcare issues that affect the community's **physical mobility**. This area's major industries relate to agriculture and other fields that include **manual labor**, so those who have **severe physical injuries** are significantly limited in their **ability to work** in the economy. These injuries can be cured through **physical rehabilitation** treatment, however, the **Chankanai Divisional Hospital** (the largest community hospital in the area) **does not currently have the equipment needed** for this kind of intensive treatment.



Shoulder pain



Arm pain

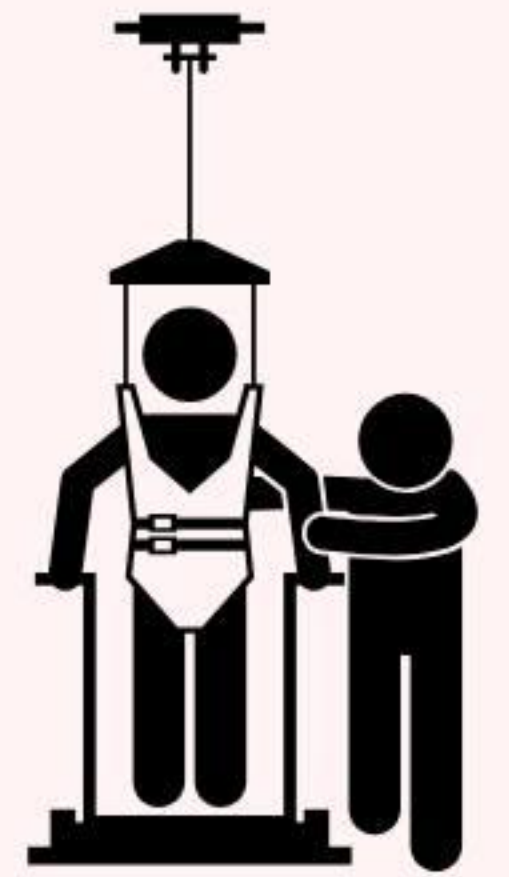


Leg pain



Back and Spinal Pain

Solution: Our project, **Karunisai**, aims to alleviate physical issues for the general population of the Chankanai community through **raising funds to purchase physical rehabilitation equipment** for the **Chankanai Divisional Hospital**. This way, we are able to provide a sustainable solution that can help the community for decades to come and create a lasting impact. The Karunisai event will feature **two live performances** of **Carnatic music**, a traditional South Asian classical music style, to raise awareness of our cause and celebrate South Asian and Srilankan culture. Additionally, we will **send recordings of the music** to the hospital for patients to enjoy and to support their holistic healing and rehabilitation through **musopathy**.



PLANNING

PROJECT GOALS:

1) Raise \$15,000 for physical rehabilitation equipment



2) Promote holistic healing through Carnatic music



3) Foster Awareness in Community via Cultural Engagement



OUR TEAM:



Saanvi Subramanian
Project Lead
Marketing Coordinator



Prisha Kuberan
Project Lead
Logistics Coordinator



Kaustubh Grama
Project Lead
Music Coordinator



Ganesh Rajagopalan
Music Composer



Temple of Music
Event Sponsor



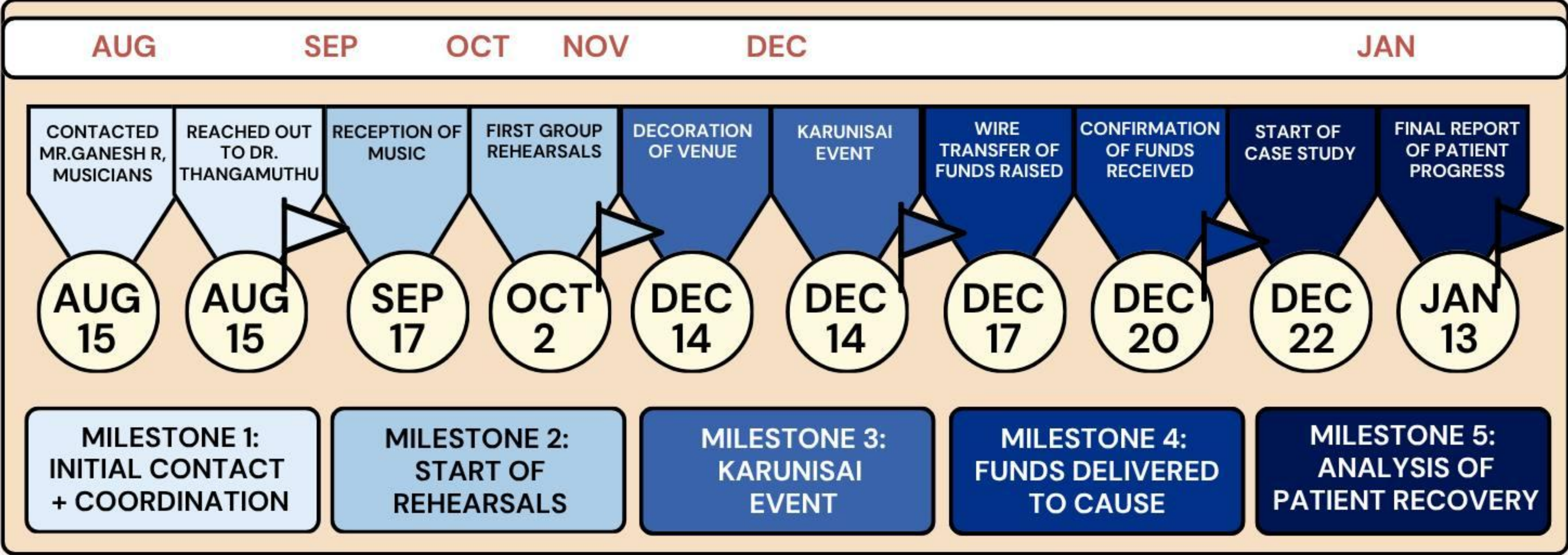
eSvara School of Performing Arts
Carnatic Musicians



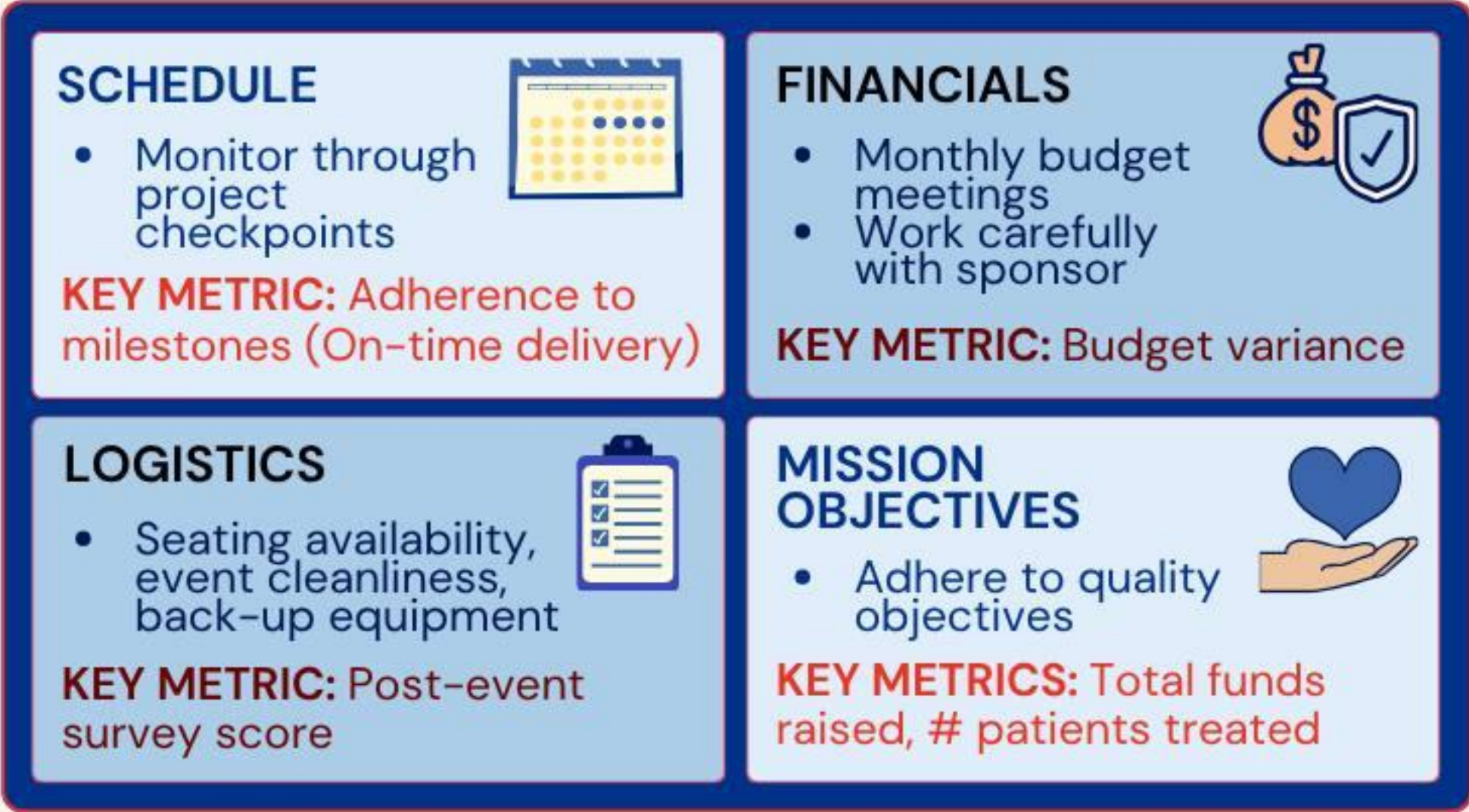
Sathiyamoorthy Thangamuthu
Lead Doctor at
Chankanai Divisional Hospital

PROPOSED BUDGET:

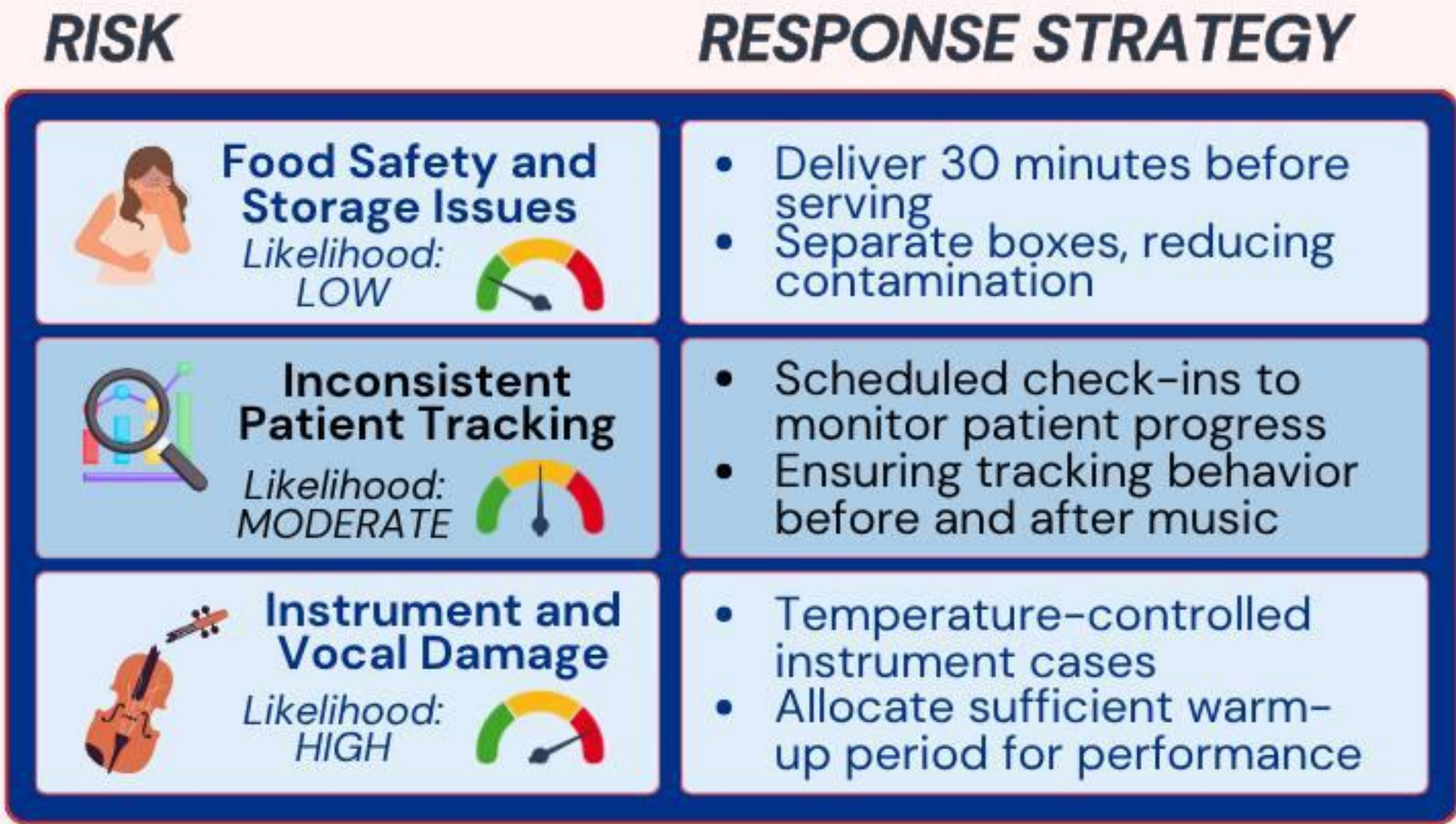
ITEM:	TOTAL COST:
Stage Decor.....	\$0.00
Welcome Table.....	\$0.00
Microphones.....	\$246.00
Kirkland Venue.....	\$1,700.00
Program Flyers.....	\$750.00
Food.....	\$0.00
GRAND TOTAL:	\$2,696.00



QUALITY MANAGEMENT PLAN:



RISK MANAGEMENT PLAN:



EXECUTION

MILESTONE 1: INITIAL CONTACT AND COORDINATION



- Secure Ganesh Rajagopalan to compose Carnatic music pieces
- Recruit musician team from eSwara School of Performing Arts
- Obtain confirmation of event sponsorship from Temple of Music non-profit
- Connect with lead doctor of Chankanai Divisional Hospital
- Reserve Kirkland Performing Arts Center for Saturday, December 14

MILESTONE 2: START OF REHEARSALS



- Musicians learn pieces and reach fluency as an ensemble
- Ganesh Rajagopalan to finish pieces, choosing Ragas (scales) known for rejuvenation
- Contacted musicians for availabilities to create rehearsal schedules
- Musicians held smaller. more focused rehearsals with others who played same parts
- Ganesh Rajagopalan attended rehearsals to ensure quality of ensemble

ADVERTISING AND TICKET SELLING

- Designed flyers and distributed to South Asian community centers
- Utilized digital marketing through Facebook and Whatsapp
- Sold tickets through Sulekha, a South Asian event management platform



MILESTONE 3: KARUNISAI EVENT

- Karunisai held on Saturday, December 14th, at Kirkland Performing Arts Center
- Shows from 2:00 PM to 4:00 PM and 6:00 PM to 8:00 PM
- \$20 per ticket with free admission for children under 10
- 2 productions to maximize sales and minimize venue costs & set-up time
- **585 total paying guests**
 - 249 in the first show, 336 in the second show
- Raised \$11,700 through ticket sales, \$659 through donations
- Doubled donation through Microsoft Matching Gifts Program
- Total contribution = \$24,718



MILESTONE 4: DONATION OF FUNDS RAISED

- Wire transfer \$24,718 from Temple of Music to Chankanai Divisional Hospital
- Confirmed funds transfer with head of hospital Dr. Thangamuthu
- Hospital purchase of 150 stationary bicycles and 100 parallel bars
- Informed that proceeds will benefit 150+ patients annually
- Sent curated therapeutic recordings of Carnatic pieces to complement physical therapy sessions



MILESTONE 5: ANALYSIS OF PATIENT RECOVERY

- Identified bipolar patient who consented to have progress tracked
- Started one month long case study with musopathy
- Each week focused on a different raga known for therapeutic properties
- Patient exhibited significant improvements in emotional regulation, focus, and engagement in rehabilitation activities



MONITORING



Created schedule checkpoints for each milestone



Held budget reviews, tracked expenses with Excel



Implemented a quality management plan to ensure project operated smoothly, and audience satisfaction of event

CONTROLLING



Damp weather conditions in performance venue



Cyclone warning lockdowns



Low number of sold tickets



Controlled room temperature of venue



Rearranged rehearsal and practice schedule



Diversified selling methods through additional channels

CLOSING THE PROJECT

LESSONS LEARNED

- ★ Delegating tasks is extremely important to simplify project roles
- ★ Ensure the project schedule is flexible and communicate changes clearly
- ★ Marketing to a broader audience allows for higher impact generated

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR FUTURE PROJECTS

- ★ Expand community engagement and marketing channels
- ★ Strengthen strategic partnerships for greater impact
- ★ Implementation of metrics to measure long-term success

II. INITIATING

A. Statement of the Problem

Chankanai is a small rural Tamil town in Sri Lanka that has been severely impacted by the **Sri Lankan Civil War**, which has brought the region into poverty and caused many civilians to have to perform **strenuous manual labor** just to keep themselves alive. Individuals work 6–7 days per week for over 12 hours a day under unsafe and hazardous conditions. These **physically demanding jobs** increase the risk of injury, including muscle strains, joint injuries and chronic pain. Unfortunately, access to medical care and specialized rehabilitation services is severely restricted or does not exist at all in these impoverished communities. Without necessary equipment, many injuries become chronic conditions, which inhibits people's ability to work. For those who survived the war and are counting on their hard labor to feed their families, the lack of proper medical equipment creates a barrier towards proper recovery.



30%

According to Department of Census and Statistics of Sri Lanka, Labour Force, ~30% of Sri Lankan population working in agriculture are at risk for work related musculoskeletal disorders

14%

~14% of the Sri Lankan community was affected by chronic musculoskeletal ankle disorders

34%

Prevalence of musculoskeletal pain in neck and/or upper limbs was 33.8%

Musculoskeletal dysfunction is a leading cause of disability worldwide, which interferes with the functioning of the body and greatly **hampers mobility**. It can force people to early retirement from the labor market and leads to economic hardship. Apart from the physical load, individuals suffering from musculoskeletal diseases lose mental well-being, have reduced capacity for community life, and lead a **lower quality of life**.

This disorder is a **serious issue** in the **northern part of Sri Lanka**, particularly due to the region's reliance on **physically demanding jobs** such as agriculture, fishing, and other labor-intensive professions. These jobs expose workers to **intense motions, heavy lifting, and risky working conditions**, which **increase their risk of musculoskeletal disorders**. The aftermath of the country's civil war also adds to this crisis, as **many individuals not only sustain physical wounds but also the mental impact of trauma**. This further hinders people from getting well and returning to their jobs, resulting in the **severe economic decline**.



Shoulder pain



Arm pain



Leg pain



Back and spinal pain

However, funding healthcare centers to supply local clinics with physiotherapy equipment can yield long-term remedies for this prevalent issue. Expanding access to rehabilitation equipment would allow people to recover more effectively and avoid further injury. This is crucial to enhancing the wellbeing and health of civilians in these areas, offering them an access point to undergo the treatment necessary to recover and lead healthier, more productive lives.

B. Project scope

DESCRIPTION OF PROJECT

The aim of this project was to **raise funds** for the Chankanai community to supply **physiotherapy equipment** to a local hospital to benefit individuals with **musculoskeletal dystrophy** and avoid further **life-threatening injuries** in rural Sri Lankan communities. To achieve this, we partnered with the **Temple of Music** in Redmond, WA, organizing performances that specialized in classical South Asian music genres, namely **Carnatic music**. Along with the new physio-equipment, we aimed to raise funds for, we wished to give our audience a **unique cultural experience** and also help hospitals incorporate Carnatic music as a **neurotherapy** tool due to its scientifically proven calming and therapeutic effects.



Carnatic Ensemble Performance



Chankanai Divisional Hospital



Physiotherapy Equipment supplemented with Carnatic Recordings



Temple of Music Venue & Sponsor



Carnatic Music Ensemble performance



Arm and leg physiotherapy equipment and treatment

PURPOSE

The primary goal of our project is to harness the power of **Carnatic music** to **raise funds** for the procurement of **physical therapy equipment** for the **Chankanai Divisional Hospital** in Sri Lanka. We also aim to provide **emotional** and **psychological** boost through Carnatic music recordings. Insufficient physical therapy equipment in the majority of Sri Lankan hospitals **decelerates patient recovery**, and through fundraising, we aim to purchase equipment that will **enhance rehabilitation care**.

The therapeutic qualities of Carnatic music, its melody, and rhythm are known to **relieve pain and stress** and create a therapeutic environment that supplements physical therapy. We arranged to send a selection of **10 recordings** of **Carnatic music** to the hospital for use in the physiotherapy. The project facilitates **connection** and **community development** by celebrating and sharing the rich **cultural heritage** of South Asia and Sri Lanka. Through our project, we hope to make the lives of these patients more **meaningful** and assist in their **holistic recovery**.

physio therapy



Physiotherapy aims to restore **movement and function** in individuals affected by **injury, illness, or disability** through the use of **exercises** and **manual therapy**, ultimately helping people **improve their quality of life**.

RATIONALE

Rural communities in Sri Lanka often face significant **healthcare inequities**, including limited access to essential resources like **physiotherapy equipment**, which is crucial for rehabilitating **musculoskeletal disorders**. These untreated or poorly managed conditions can **severely impact mobility** and overall quality of life.

To address this pressing need, our project takes an **innovative** approach by combining **physiotherapy** with **musopathy**—the therapeutic use of music for **healing**. Specifically, we will use Carnatic music, a classical form of South India, as both fundraiser and therapy. This dual strategy takes advantage of the scientifically established benefits of music therapy and adds the cultural and emotional connection Carnatic music offers, resulting in a highly effective treatment for these disadvantaged groups.

Physiotherapy: Many hospitals in Sri Lanka, like those in Chankanai, lack essential physiotherapy equipment. Our goal is to provide modern devices to these hospitals, improving care in underrepresented and war-affected areas. This will help patients regain independence, prevent health issues, and improve their well-being.

Carnatic music: This rich classical tradition from South India, is uniquely suited for this project for several reasons:

- Scientific Benefits
 - Rhythms (tala) and melodies (raga) enhance mood, acuity, and stress relief
 - Ragas like Anandabhairavi and Hamsanandi promote pain relief and relaxation
- Cultural Relevance
 - Resonates with South Asian populations, enhancing potential impact
- Fundraising Potential
 - Live performances combine cultural appreciation with fundraising, allowing awareness and donations



Musopathy: Musopathy, on the other hand, combines music and healing to reduce stress, pain, and recovery. Dr. Goshal's research at Johns Hopkins University suggests that music improves brain function, coordinates the brain and reduces the need for medication. Together with physiotherapy, it is an comprehensive, effective method for recovery.

EXPECTED BENEFITS



- Raise funds for physiotherapy rehabilitation equipment in Chankanai
 - Emphasis on recovery equipment for the legs, arms, and back
 - **150 physiotherapy devices**



- Aid rehabilitation patients with the soothing and therapeutic properties of Carnatic music
- Supplement the physical recovery process with mental stimulation and support



- Raise awareness about socioeconomic and healthcare inequalities in Sri Lanka



- Promote South Asian culture through cultural music and connect with the broader community

III. PLANNING AND ORGANIZING

A. Project goals

1) Raise \$15,000 for physical rehabilitation equipment



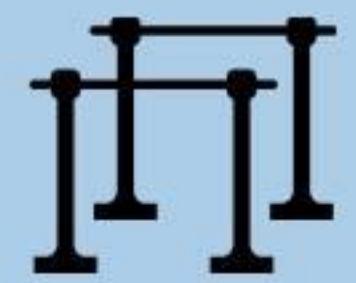
The primary objective of this project is to **raise funds** to purchase **physiotherapy** devices to support the **rehabilitative journey** of patients of Chankanai Divisional Hospital. We aim to raise enough money to provide **150 devices** to the hospital. We have provided a cost analysis for both devices. The equipment names are shown on the left, with the amount in **Rupees/USD** on the right. We will obtain funds for this project through ticket sales of our event, *Karunisai*, priced at **\$20** for adults, with **free entry** for those under the **age of 10**. We will double our funds by taking advantage of the **Microsoft Matching Gifts** program. With this pricing, we need to sell **375 tickets** to reach our fundraising goal.

Stationary Bike



SLR 26612.35
USD 99

Parallel Bars



SLR 26612.35
USD 99

2) Promote holisting healing with Carnatic music



Our secondary objective is to **develop** a **library** of 10 therapeutic Carnatic music recordings **specifically curated to complement physiotherapy by reducing stress, alleviating pain, and enhancing the recovery process**. By harnessing the healing power of **musopathy**, we can further **advance our primary goal of supporting Sri Lankans in their healing**. We aim to **collaborate with the healthcare personnel of Chankanai Divisional Hospital** to systematically incorporate these recordings into treatment plans, benefiting an estimated **100+ patients per year**.

3) Foster community awareness via cultural engagement



Our tertiary goal for this project is to hold two **Carnatic music performances** in partnership with the **Temple of Music**, a 501c(3) **nonprofit** organization led by Carnatic violinist **Ganesh Rajagopalan**. Through **promotional** efforts, we aim to attract at least **200 attendees** per performance and raise at least **\$15,000**. We will use these events to bring attention to the applications of **musotherapy** in patient therapies and the healthcare inequalities faced in rural Sri Lanka, creating a platform to **advocate** for Sri Lankans while celebrating **South Asian cultural heritage** and spreading it throughout the greater Seattle area.

B. Human resource management plan

Our team consisted of three DECA members who organized and ran the Karunisai event, the Temple of Music President, the Chankanai Divisional Hospital Liaison, and the musicians who partook in the productions.



SAANVI SUBRAMANIAN – Project Lead and Marketing Coordinator

Responsibilities: Designing posters, finding a ticket selling platform and enabling its use, connecting with local temples and community organizations, advertising through online platforms

Strengths and skills: Social media, graphic design, event marketing, and advertisement

She advertised the Karunisai event and sold tickets through Sulekha, an online platform. She designed posters to spread the word and shared them with local organizations and online social media platforms including Whatsapp and Facebook.



PRISHA KUBERAN – Project Lead and Logistics Coordinator

Responsibilities: Managing finances, contacting external contributors, finding a suitable venue, and overseeing strategic planning to ensure the success of the initiative

Strengths and skills: Strong leadership, project management, communication

She led the logistics, strategic planning, and financial aspects of the project. She managed finances and played a crucial role in planning both the Karunisai event and the case study with Dr. Thangamuthu.



KAUSTUBH GRAMA – Project Lead and Musician Coordinator

Responsibilities: Leading the project, organizing music arrangements, coordinating rehearsals, initiating contact with Temple of Music, and ensuring the execution of the entire initiative

Strengths and skills: Financial acumen, strategic planning, communication

He took initiative in making the initial contact to Temple of Music and Ganesh Rajagopalan. He also recruited a troupe of musicians from eSvara School of Performing arts and secured the venue for Karunisai.



GANESH RAJAGOPALAN – Temple of Music President and Composer

Responsibilities: Composing Carnatic pieces for musotherapy to stimulate holistic healing, garners recognition as the face of concert events, lead musician rehearsals

Strengths and skills: Carnatic music expertise, face recognition, parent coordinator

He composed the pieces that were played at our concerts as well as the music that was sent to the Chankanai Divisional Hospital to be played for patients and promote holistic healing through musopathy.



TEMPLE OF MUSIC – Hospital Liaison and Event Sponsor

Responsibilities: Connecting with the hospital, securing funding, fostering collaboration, and advertising to South Asians in the Seattle area and listeners of cultural and classical music

Strengths and skills: Communication, community engagement, financial systems

The Temple of Music graciously offered to sponsor the event, covering all the costs associated with the project so that we could maximize our contribution to Chankanai Divisional Hospital. They also helped with event promotion across their existing connections with South Asians and Carnatic music enthusiasts.

CARNATIC MUSIC PERFORMERS FROM ESWARA SCHOOL OF PERFORMING ARTS



Responsibilities: Learning and performing music pieces, actively participating in rehearsals, hosting sectional practice sections and contributing to the artistic success of Karunisai

Strengths and skills: Carnatic music expertise, teamwork, commitment

The Carnatic musicians were recruited from Ganesh Rajagopalan's eSwara School of Performing Arts in Redmond, Washington. They were integral to the success of Karunisai, offering their musical experience and coming together for intensive rehearsals.

DR. SATHIYAMOORTHY THANGAMUTHU – Lead Doctor at Chankanai Divisional Hospital



Responsibilities: Managing hospital finances, receiving funds and providing confirmation, identifying needs of hospital physiotherapy division, ordering physiotherapy devices with funds

Strengths and skills: Finance, medical expertise, connection with physiotherapy doctors

He was the primary point of contact for the Chankanai Divisional Hospital. He confirmed the delivery of our funds through wire transfer and was responsible for the final step of purchasing the physiotherapy devices. Additionally, he helped us execute our musotherapy case study.

C. Schedule

i. Milestone



MILESTONE 1: INITIAL CONTACT AND COORDINATION



Description: In the first milestone, we completed reaching out and **contacting** all the parties and organizations we collaborated with to create **Karunisai**. We utilized Kaustubh's connection to recruit Carnatic music expert **Ganesh Rajagopalan** to be the **artistic director**, who would **compose** the music for the performances that we would send for **musotherapy** at Chankanai Divisional Hospital. We also identified 11 violinists and 11 vocalists from **eSwara School of Performing Arts**. For the venue, we used Temple of Music's existing connections to reserve the **Kirkland Performing Arts Center** for Saturday, **December 14th**. This milestone also consists of devising a detailed schedule, setting goals, and identifying resources, marking the end of the initial stages.

Activities: Initial discussions, project proposal, communication with ToM, eSwara, Ganesh Rajagopalan, and venue.

Outcome: Confirmation of collaboration, project planning and viability, venue reservation.



MILESTONE 2: START OF REHEARSALS

Description: Once we received confirmation that Ganesh Rajagopalan finished composing the pieces, we began **rehearsals** with the musicians. Rehearsals were **intensive**: two hours, three times a week over a three month period. This included **separate** rehearsals for each section of musicians', to ensure that everyone is in sync with their partners. Rehearsals were held at eSwara School of Performing Arts in Redmond, Washington and musician's residences as they volunteered for sectional sessions.

Activities: Completion of composition, starting rehearsals, establishing musician sections.

Outcome: Music pieces finalized, ensuring quality performance through comprehensive practice and revision.

MILESTONE 3: KARUNISAI EVENT



Description: We held **Karunisai** on Saturday, **December 14th** at the **Kirkland Performing Arts Center**. There were two performances to **maximize** profits: one from 2:00 PM to 4:00 PM and one from 6:00 PM to 8:00 PM. Holding them on the same day helped to **minimize** costs with venue rental. We sold tickets for \$20 and offered **free** attendance for children ten and under. Before the performances began, we invited Ganesh Rajagopalan to **speak** about the cause of **inadequate access** to healthcare in Sri Lanka, especially relating to physical therapy.

Activities: Decorating the venue, two showings of Karunisai music performances, posters and presentations on cause.

Outcome: Funds raised in ticket sales, increased awareness about healthcare inequities in Sri Lanka.

MILESTONE 4: FUNDS DELIVERED TO CAUSE



Description: After **Karunisai**, we **donated** the money from our account to the Temple of Music, using the **Microsoft Matching Gifts** program to receive **corporate matching** for our proceeds. The Temple of Music then **wire transferred** the funds directly to Chankanai Divisional Hospital so they could purchase **physiotherapy devices** as per the needs of their patients.

Activities: Wire transfer of collected funds from Temple of Music to Chankanai Divisional Hospital, confirm money transfer.

Outcome: Provide access to physiotherapy devices for residents of Chankanai, donate funds raised, ensure quality.

MILESTONE 5: ANALYSIS OF PATIENT RECOVERY

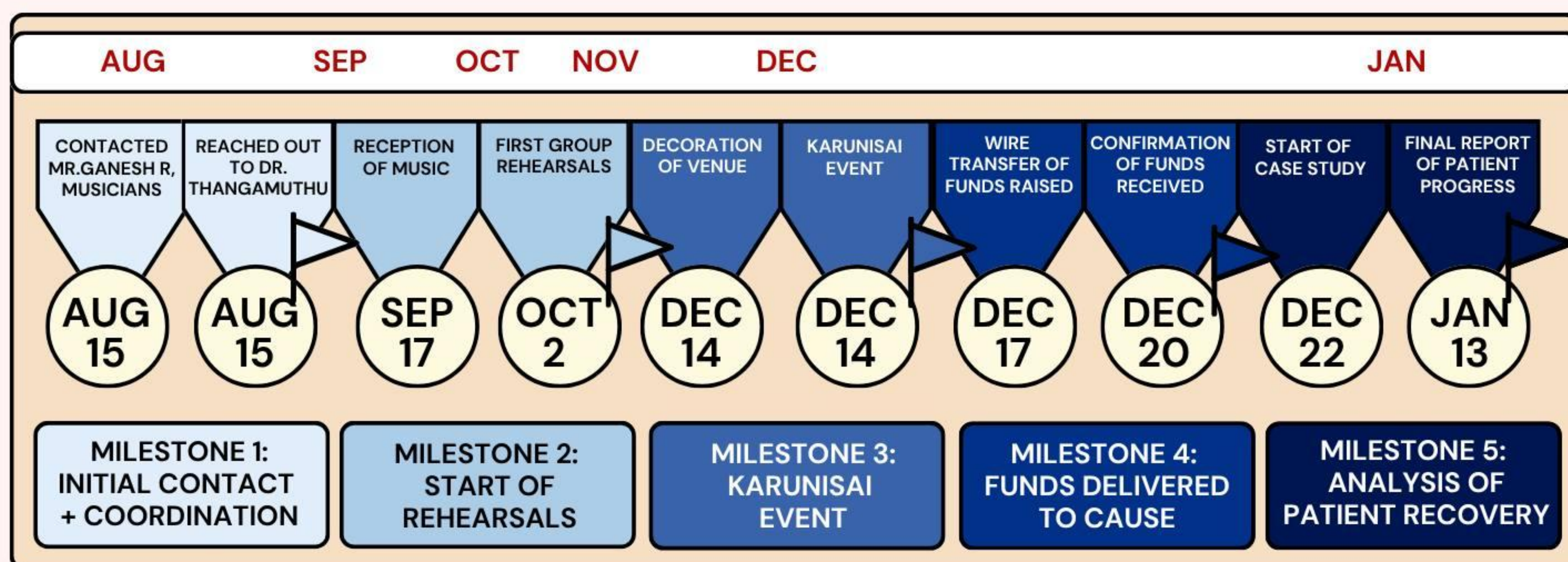


Description: After donating the funds, we planned to work with Dr. Thangamuthu at Chankanaai Divisional Hospital to implement our therapeutic Carnatic music library into **physiotherapy sessions** for a 21-year-old woman with **bipolar disorder**. The trial was set to run from Dec 22 to Jan 13, with weekly reports showing **significant improvements** in her **emotional regulation, focus, and social engagement**.

Activities: Integrating the Carnatic music into physiotherapy sessions, collecting weekly reports on patient's progress, tracking impact of raga on mood and behavior.

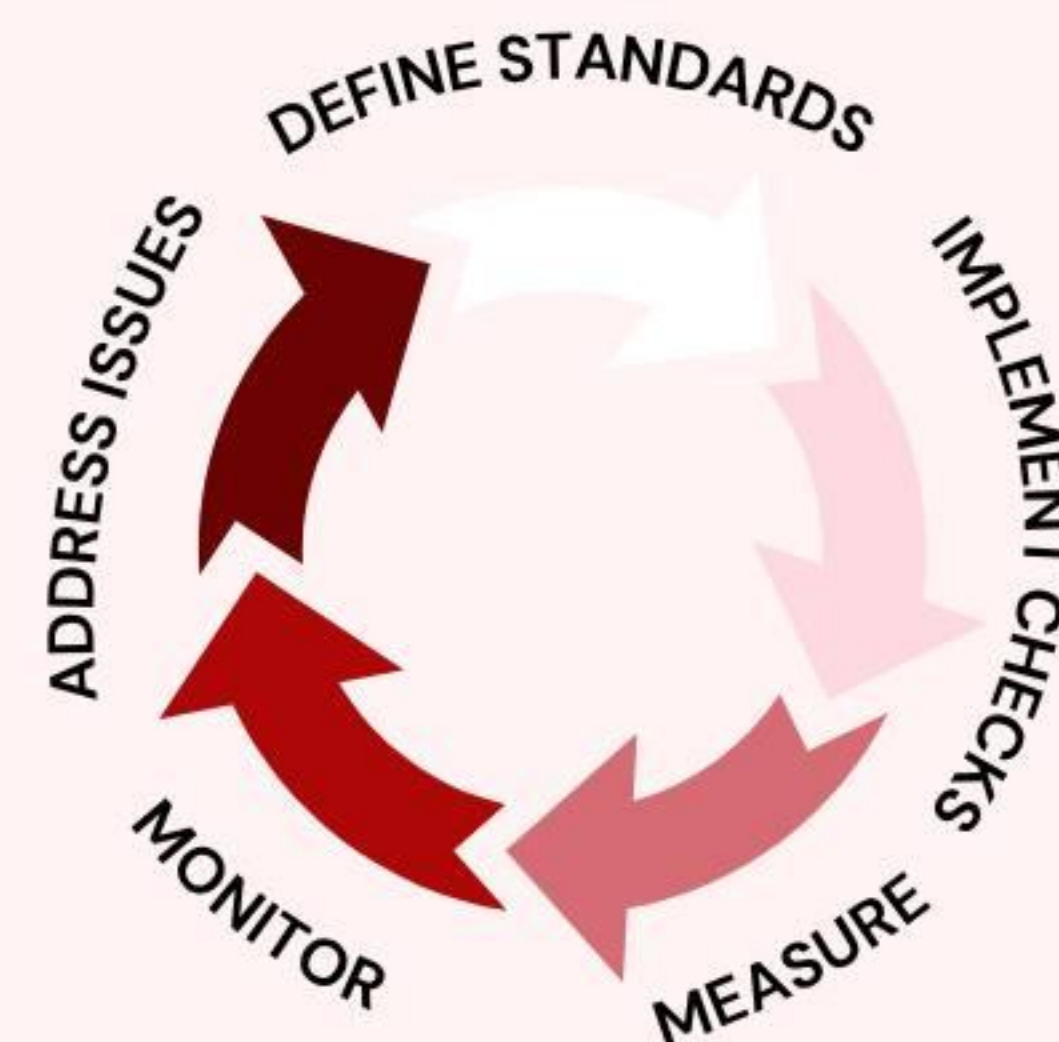
Outcome: Highlight the potential of Carnatic music as a therapeutic tool for mental health and rehabilitation.

ii. Timeline to reach each milestone

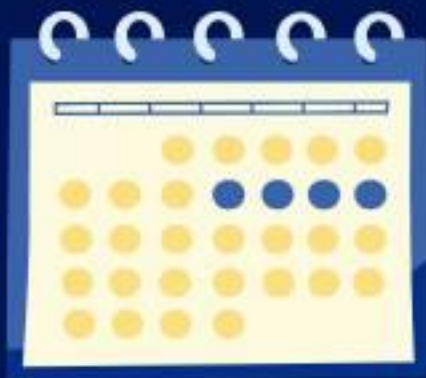


D. Quality management plan

We developed a **comprehensive 4-step quality plan** to guarantee smooth execution of our project. This involved aligning of our efforts with the intended results in areas of **schedule, financial, logistics, and overall mission goals**. Our quality management approach entailed **defining clear quality standards, control measure monitoring, and offering a plan to address and resolve any potential issues the event**. We established effective channels of communication to ensure that any quality issues were addressed on the spot. We also tracked key quality metrics, as well as overall metrics such as the number of attendees and ticket sales.



SCHEDULE



Ensuring the schedule involves having mechanisms that ensure the timeliness of event parameters. We will **schedule regular checkpoints** to validate the venue's availability and preparations leading to the event. Validations on preparations include **signage at the event, setting up the event hall, marking the parking areas**, and ensuring the availability of parking access. We set up **additional checkpoints on weather conditions and potential events** in the neighborhood to prepare for contingencies.

KEY METRICS: *Adherence to milestones (On-time delivery)*

FINANCIALS



We worked within **strict constraints** on the allocated **budget**. We set up **monthly reviews** on cost incurrence and **deviations** from the budget. We also recognized the need to ensure a safe, trusted way of receiving donations from our patrons. We diligently reviewed vendor products to identify the most reliable means for donations that comprehensively address **privacy and identity risks**. Our chosen vendor met industry and regulatory standards for financial certifications.

KEY METRICS: *Budget variance*

LOGISTICS



Our team conducted **rigorous checks** to ensure the program ran smoothly and that the performers and attendees had a great experience. To this end, **we set up an extensive list of event logistics**—availability of seating, cleanliness of event space, and setting up backup microphones—to name a few. We will also send out a **post-event survey** to attendees to measure their satisfaction with the event.

KEY METRICS: *Post-event survey score*

MISSION OBJECTIVES



Finally, we defined **quality objectives** for the impact of the entire project, which ultimately was the number of **people treated** from the funds raised. We ensured successful transfer of the **funds**, and measured impact from the donations to **confirm** that the funds delivered the intended objective.

KEY METRICS: *Total funds raised, number of patients treated*

DESCRIPTION OF KEY METRICS

- **Adherence to milestones:** number of milestones missed divided by number of total milestones
- **Budget variance:** final cost – predicted cost
- **Post-event survey score:** the score calculated from the survey given to attendees after the event to measure satisfaction
- **Total funds raised:** the amount of money generated through ticket sales and donation
- **Number of patients treated:** the total amount of patients treated in Chankanai Divisional Hospital as a result of our efforts

E. Risk management plan

RISK	IMPACT	RESPONSE STRATEGY
 Food Safety and Storage Issues Likelihood: LOW 	If food is served at the wrong temperature or is contaminated, it could lead to foodborne illnesses and spoil the event.	• Delivery max 30 minutes before serving • Separate boxes to reduce cross contamination • Leave food at safe temperatures to prevent bacterial growth
 Inconsistent Patient Tracking Likelihood: MODERATE 	Inconsistent tracking of the patient's progress could result in inaccurate or incomplete data, compromising the effectiveness of our study.	• Clear instructions for tracking • Scheduled check-ins to monitor patient progress • Ensuring that personnel are tracking behavior before and after music is played
 Instrument and Vocal Damage Likelihood: HIGH 	Weather changes could affect the condition of the instruments and the vocalists' ability to perform, potentially leading to damaged instruments or strained voices.	• Temperature controlled instrument cases • Provide vocalists hot water with honey • Allocate sufficient warm-up period before performance

F. Proposed project budget

ITEM	COST PER ITEM	#	TOTAL COST
Stage Decor	In-Kind from eSwara	1	\$0.00
Welcome Table Decor	In-Kind from eSwara	1	\$0.00
Microphones	\$20.50	12	\$246.00
Kirkland Arts Center	\$170.00/hour	10 hrs	\$1,700.00
Program Flyers	\$1.50	500	\$750.00
Food	In-Kind from eSwara	650	\$0.00
GRAND TOTAL			\$2,696.00

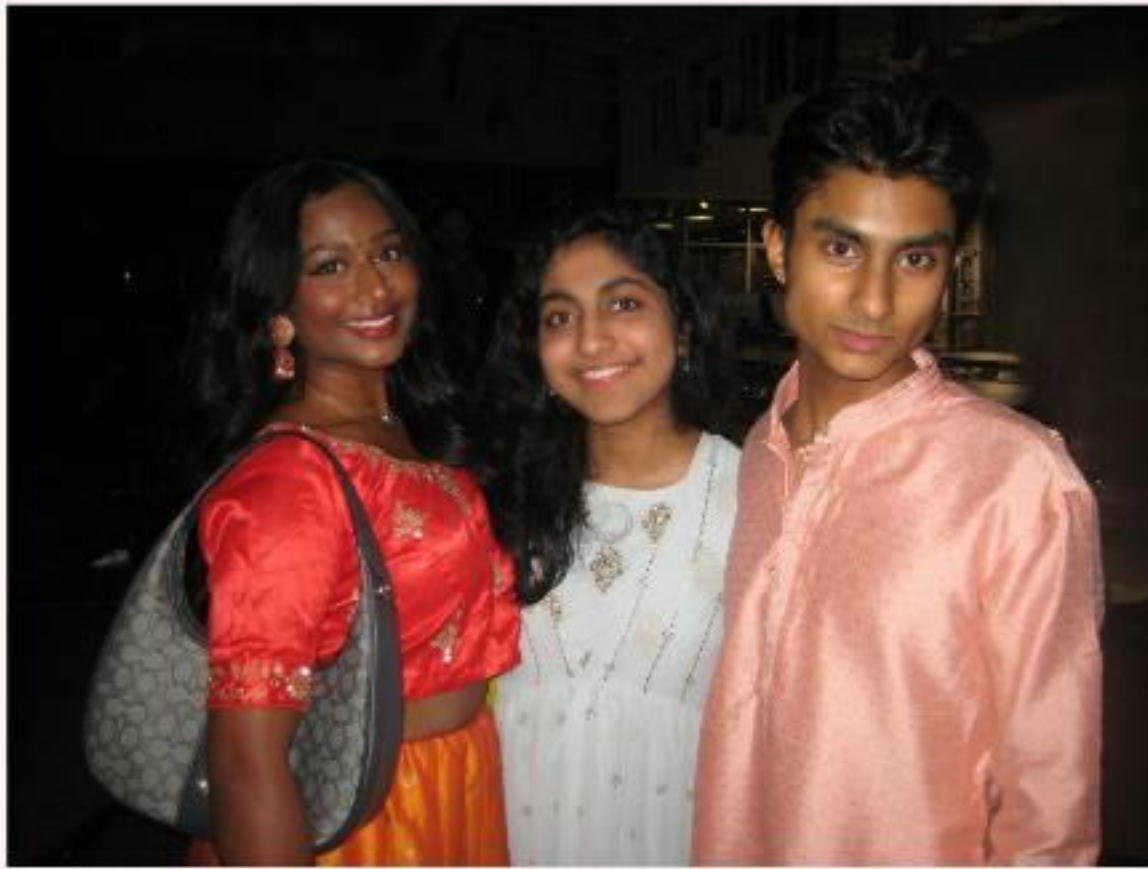
The Temple of Music generously offered to cover up to **\$3,000** for the program's expenses. To keep costs low, we sought out **donations** and aimed to **maximize** the **contributions** of our attendees. **eSwara School of Performing Arts** helped with decorations, many of which were reused from previous events. A volunteer from eSwara, who owns a local Indian restaurant, also sponsored the food for the event, providing 650 food boxes —350 vegetarian and 300 non-vegetarian. Furthermore, we were able to secure speakers and chairs at no cost from the Kirkland Performing Arts Center. **In total, we estimated the budget for the Karunisai event to be \$2,696.00.**

IV. EXECUTION

MILESTONE 1: INITIAL CONTACT AND COORDINATION



Through Kaustubh's connection to the **Temple of Music** and **eSvara School of Performing Arts**, we contacted **Ganesh Rajagopalan** and conveyed our cause and using music to **promote healing**. He assumed the role of **artistic director** and began **composing** the pieces we needed. He also helped finalize the **concept** and **logistics** of holding Carnatic Music performances. Next, we selected **11 vocalists** and **11 violinists** from eSvara to perform, along with 3 emergency understudies in each. Once our ensemble had been recruited, we leveraged Temple of Music's existing connections with **Kirkland Performing Arts Center** to secure a venue and date for the event. Finally, we coordinated with the doctors of the **Chankanai Divisional Hospital** through email to brief them on our efforts and maintained routine communication throughout the duration of the project execution.



Project Lead Team: Prisha, Saanvi, and Kaustubh, at Karunisai



Temple of Music



Ganesh Rajagopalan



Chankanai Divisional Hospital

MILESTONE 2: START OF REHEARSALS



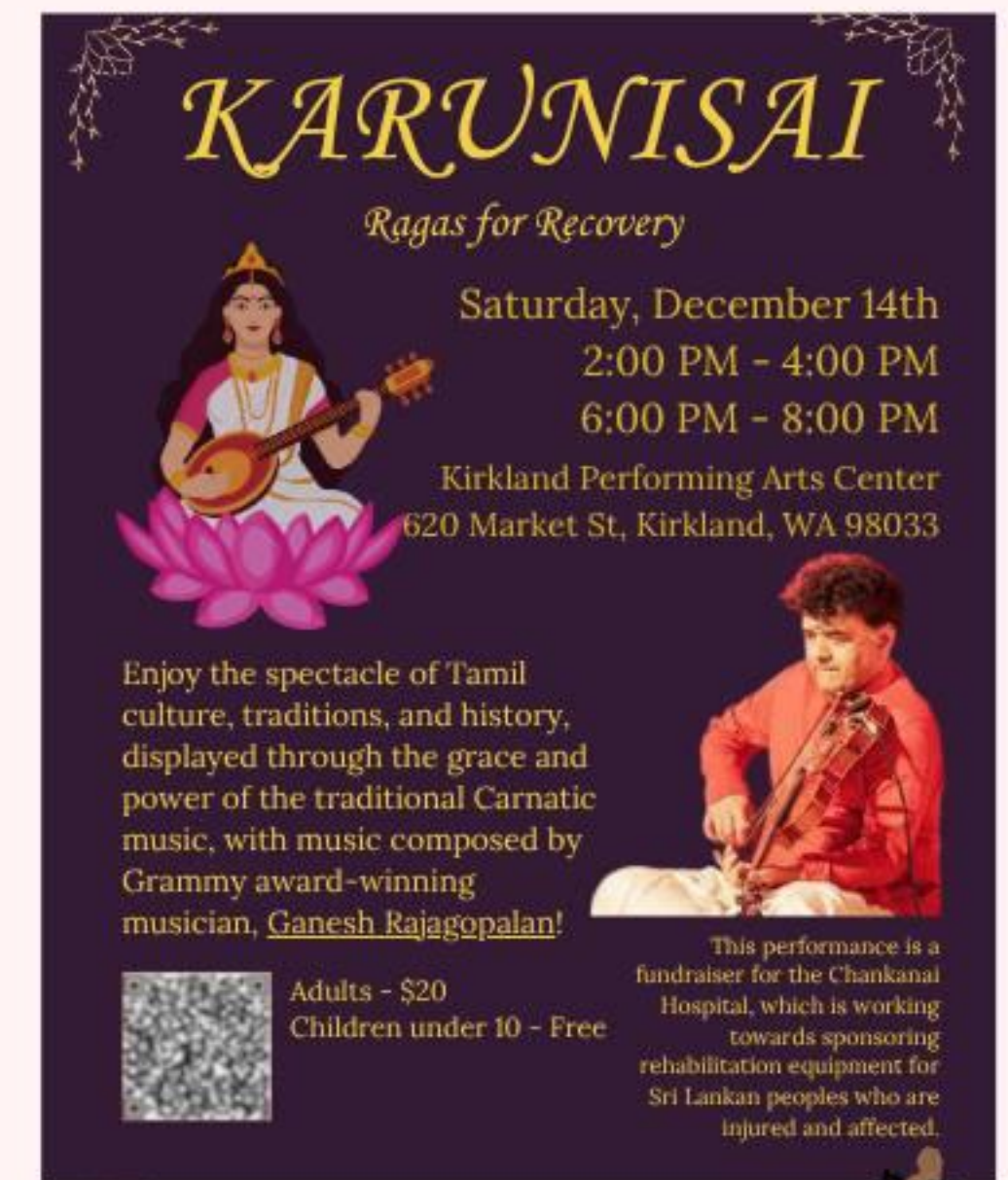
A **raga** in Carnatic music is a **melodic framework** of specific notes designed to evoke distinct **emotions** and **moods**, often linked to **therapeutic** effects on the mind and body. The 10 recordings were carefully curated with specific ragas, each selected for its **healing** properties. Three songs featured Raga Sankarabharanam, known for promoting **emotional balance and clarity**. Two were based on Raga Madhyamavati, valued for its **calming and stress-relieving qualities**. Two utilized Raga Hamsadhwani, a **cheerful and energizing** raga. The remaining three songs were in Raga Mayamalava-gowla, often associated with **enhancing focus and mindfulness**.

Rehearsals for the songs were held for **two hours, three times a week for three months** leading up to Karunisai. To confirm musicians availabilities, we asked them to populate a **spreadsheet** with their **availabilities** throughout the week, from which we selected the times that most people could make. Once the rehearsal schedule was set, the other performers **rearranged** their **commitments** accordingly. Additionally, some of the artists who played the same part arranged to meet independently for sectional rehearsals for extra practice to ensure they were contributing their best to the ensemble.

ADVERTISING AND TICKET SELLING

Saanvi was in charge of **advertising** the Karunisai event and finding and setting up the **ticket-selling** platform. She designed the **flyers** shown to the right. She distributed them to **Hindu temples** and **Tamil schools** around the greater Seattle area to attract the South Asian community and local businesses willing to promote the event. She also realized that **digital advertising** would be effective, as it could better target South Asian people who may be interested in this cultural event and allow for easier spreading of the event information. She sent out **digital copies** of the flyer on platforms such as **Facebook** and **WhatsApp** to attract **family audiences** of South Asians and others who may be interested in learning more about its culture.

She chose to sell tickets for the event through the platform **Sulekha**, an online platform dedicated to South Asian community events. She thought it would be a perfect platform for Karunisai and another channel by which we could **advertise** the event. Sulekha also does not charge a commission fee, so no operating costs were associated with the platform, another driving factor contributing to our choice. We also offered the opportunity to purchase tickets **at the door**.



MILESTONE 3: KARUNISAI EVENT

The Karunisai events were held on Saturday, **December 14th** at the **Kirkland Performing Arts Center**. We held **two events**, one from 2:00 PM to 4:00 PM and one from 6:00 PM to 8:00 PM, so we could maximize ticket sales. By holding the events on the same day, we minimized the time we spent using the venue and therefore **reduced the costs associated**. The performers arrived at 12:00 PM for sound check and final rehearsals while volunteers helped to decorate and set up a ticket booth for same day ticket sales. They also posted informational posters about our cause around the venue with QR codes to donate directly. Before each performance, we invited **Ganesh Rajagopalan** to **highlight the healthcare inequalities present in rural Sri Lanka**, helping us achieve our secondary goal of raising awareness. The performance consisted of 10 Carnatic pieces, composed by Ganesh Rajagopalan, in ragas chosen for their relaxing and restorative properties.

Between the two events, we welcomed **602 guests total**, out of which 585 were paying guests, 249 in the first showing and 336 in the second showing, raising **\$11,700 through ticket sales** and **\$659 through direct donations** for a **total amount of \$12,359**. We then met with a Temple of Music member who was a Microsoft Employee. They helped us double our contribution to the hospital by applying for corporate matching through the **Microsoft Matching Gifts program**, for a total amount of **\$24,718**.



MILESTONE 4: FUNDS DELIVERED TO CAUSE



Following the performances, the project team worked with the Temple of Music to ensure the seamless transfer of funds collected from ticket sales and additional donations. The \$24,718 was wired directly to Chankanai Divisional Hospital in Sri Lanka and earmarked for the procurement of much-needed physiotherapy equipment. The funds facilitated the purchase of **150 stationary bicycles** and **100 parallel bars**, which were identified as critical tools for rehabilitation programs. Furthermore, the project included the delivery of **10 specially curated therapeutic Carnatic music recordings**. These recordings were designed to **complement physical therapy sessions**, offering a holistic approach to healing and rehabilitation. The hospital administration estimated that these resources would benefit over 150 patients annually, significantly improving the quality of care provided at the facility.



By **December 20th**, the hospital administration confirmed via email that the funds had been successfully received and allocated as intended. The Karunisai event not only achieved its financial goals but also left a **lasting impact** through its performances and the **tangible benefits it brought to those in need**.

MILESTONE 5: ANALYSIS OF PATIENT RECOVERY



Case Study: After donating, we had to measure the actual impact of our **therapeutic** Carnatic music albums. With lead doctor Dr. Thangamuthu from Chankanai Divisional Hospital and patient consent, we met a **21-year-old female** at the hospital undergoing treatment for **bipolar disorder** who agreed to participate in a **month-long case study** participant to assess the impact of the music on her mental health and **overall well-being**.

From **Dec 22nd** to **Jan 13th**, Dr. Thangamuthu began using our **Carnatic music collection** in her **physiotherapy treatments**. Each week he would email us a **brief report** of our **patient's mood** and **behavior status**:

Week 1: Beginning with Raga Maya-malava-gowla, the patient improved better in concentration and felt less tense during therapy.

Week 2: Raga Sankarabharanam helped keep her **emotionally stable**, and she participated actively in group discussions for the first time.

Week 3: With the application of Raga Madhyamavati, **stress levels reduced** for the patient, and she began engaging in creative activities like painting.

Week 4: On hearing Raga Hamsadhwani, the patient manifested **greater confidence** and better overall **attitude** towards life.

Towards the end of the trial, Dr. Thangamuthu showed significant **improvement** in her **emotional control**, **focus**, and **rehabilitation** activity participation. These results not only documented the **therapeutic** value of Carnatic music but also validated the **success** of our initiative.



V. MONITORING AND CONTROLLING

A. Monitoring

Schedule

To monitor the schedule of the project, we **established checkpoints** to ensure we were on track to achieve our milestones. By using the checkpoints below, we were able to organize dates for what needs to be completed and the process by which to address the task best. We tracked our **adherence to milestones** to assess our on time delivery. This helped us hold ourselves accountable for the completion of tasks needed to ensure the quality of the event.

SCHEDULE CHECKPOINT	DATE STARTED	PROCESS COMPLETED	DATE COMPLETED
Establish Collaboration with Musicians 	August 11th, 2024	Contacted Mr. Rajagopalan and eSvara team about cause and finalized idea and songs for event	August 15th, 2024
Contact Dr. Thangamuthu and Chankanai Hospital 	August 17th, 2024	Reached out to Dr. Thangamuthu explaining event and consent for case study	August 25th, 2024
Music Compositions 	August 16th, 2024	All 10 Carnatic songs were composed and sent for eSvara team to began practice	September 17th, 2024
Event Planning (Time, Location, Date, Concept) 	August 29th, 2024	Connected with venue and booked Kirkland Performing Arts Center	October 19th, 2024
Advertising Karunisai 	October 22nd, 2024	Distributed flyers to community organizations through digital channels and a ticketing platform	December 13th, 2024
Day of Event 	December 14th, 2024	Karunisai production set up and execution	December 14th, 2024
Funds Delivered 	December 17th, 2024	Worked with Temple of Music to send funds to Chankanai Divisional Hospital	December 20th, 2024
Report of Patient Progress 	December 22nd, 2024	Received case study results from Dr. Thangamuthu and finished analysis	January 13th, 2025

Budget

The Temple of Music graciously offered to cover all costs associated with the Karunisai events, including event decor, microphones, venue rental and advertising. We tracked our budget consumption using an Excel spreadsheet which we reviewed in bi-weekly check-ins with the Temple of Music.



Initial investment: \$2,696.00

Total revenue: \$24,718.00

Return on Investment: \$22,022



816.8% ROI

Quality

We devised a holistic quality management plan, ensuring that the quality of our project would be of the highest standard. We applied it to every step of the project, tracking results through execution until the funds were delivered and impact was validated. We proactively tracked progress on our checkpoints and informed the team of any issues so that they could be addressed in a timely manner. Our rigor on quality management was critical to the success of the program.

B. Controlling

During the preparation for the Karunisai event, we faced a few challenges. Although these obstacles could have caused delays, we had anticipated them during our risk management phase, which allowed us to handle them efficiently. As a result, the issues didn't have a major impact on the event and we were able to carry out the project successfully.

PROBLEM ENCOUNTERED



On the day of the event, **heavy rainfall and cloudy weather** threatened the quality of the sound as the instruments and performers' voices were affected by the damp conditions.



During the rehearsal period, a **week-long cyclone warning** was issued, causing all schools to shut down and preventing us from holding our practice sessions.



Ticket sales were **slower** than anticipated in the first few weeks, resulting in concerns about meeting our attendance goals for the event.

SOLUTION IMPLEMENTED



We had planned ahead by **preparing a room** with controlled temperature to maintain the instruments and we provided performers with hot water mixed with honey to soothe their voices, ensuring their sound quality was not compromised.



In response, we rearranged the schedule and worked **double** the following week to make up for lost time, ensuring that all the songs and compositions were prepared for the performance.



To address this, we intensified our marketing efforts by **reaching out to Tamil schools** and community centers to spread the word. We also used social media, which boosted ticket sales and attract a larger audience in the weeks leading up to the event.

VI. CLOSING THE PROJECT

A. Evaluation of key metrics

To best assess our progress in fulfilling our key metrics throughout the project, we established corresponding targets to which we could compare our outcomes. The outcomes and targets along with their relative metrics are displayed in the table below.

KEY METRIC	TARGET	OUTCOME	STATUS
Adherence to milestones (OTD)	0 delays	0 delays	
Budget variance	\$0	\$0	
Number of ticket sales	375	585	
Number of attendees	400	602	
Customer satisfaction score	4	4.5	

B. Lessons learned

Initiating: We were successful in the initiating phase, but faced challenges managing multiple partnerships between Temple of Music, eSvara School, Kirkland Performing Arts Center, and Chankanai Hospital.

The project operated more efficiently after focusing primarily on Temple of Music for musical direction and fund transfer, and eSvara School for our performers and donated resources.

Planning: The planning phase effectively balanced ambitious goals with realistic constraints, as shown by our detailed metrics, conservative \$2,696 budget, and backup musician plans, but we learned that **complex fund transfers between nonprofits require additional timeline buffers**. We learned the lesson of building in extra time for inter-organizational processes from this project.

Execution: Our execution demonstrated the value of leveraging existing partnerships, as shown by eSvara School's contribution of musicians and decorations which helped keep our budget under \$3,000, but revealed the need to **expand marketing beyond our core South Asian audience to maximize the impact of our dual-performance structure** at Kirkland Performing Arts Center.

Monitoring and Controlling: We were successful in establishing checkpoints and reviewing our budget. We could do better in **keeping track of ticket sales during the first couple of months to ensure that we are on the right path to meet our target**. During our controlling phase, we were successful in mitigating risks we encountered throughout the project and ensuring our team was on the same page.

C. Recommendations for future projects

Running and managing the Karunisai project has been an insightful experience, and one in which our team learned many lessons. For future projects, we recommend the following:

★ Expand Online Presence

We **successfully used WhatsApp and Facebook** to connect with South Asian audiences for the Karunisai event. In the future, we may be able to expand these efforts and **also use Instagram and YouTube** to reach more people. We can **post short videos of performances on Instagram**, and YouTube is great for sharing our project highlights and stories about patients who were helped. These platforms will help us connect with younger people and non-South Asian audiences who may also support our mission. Using **targeted ads** on these platforms can increase our visibility, boost ticket sales, and build greater support for our project.



★ Strengthen Strategic Partnerships for Greater Impact

We had good collaborations with the Temple of Music and eSwara. However, for future projects, we should start **building relationships with businesses and nonprofits earlier**. For example, many companies have programs like Microsoft Matching that can double the donations we receive. We can also **partner with healthcare organizations** or cultural groups in Sri Lanka to make our **donation process smoother**. These partnerships will provide **stability** and help us **increase our impact over time**.



★ Track Impact to Measure Long-Term Success

For the future projects, we should focus on tracking the **long-term effects of our contributions**. Metrics such as the number of patients treated or improvements in recovery rates can highlight the success of donated equipment and music therapy. Sharing these results through social media and reports will show our supporters the real difference they're making. Creating success stories about specific patients who benefited from our physiotherapy tools or Carnatic music therapy will **demonstrate the value of our project and build trust with supporters**.



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